

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 37)

Page 182 - Wordsworth's Life

Q1. Who was Wordsworth's devoted sister who lived with him as a third member of his household?

- A. Mary
- B. Dorothy
- C. Elizabeth
- D. Jane

Answer: B

Q2. What year was Wordsworth made Poet Laureate upon the death of Robert Southey?

- A. 1832
- B. 1843
- C. 1850
- D. 1860

Answer: B

Q3. In what autobiographical poem are Wordsworth's relations with the revolutionary movement described?

- A. The Excursion
- B. The Recluse
- C. The Prelude
- D. The Task

Answer: C

Q4. Which region is Wordsworth's name now always associated with?

- A. The Scottish Highlands
- B. The Lake District
- C. The Peak District
- D. The Yorkshire Dales

Answer: B

Q5. At Orleans during his second visit to France, Wordsworth formed an intimacy with an officer of Girondist views named:

- A. Beaupuis

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B. Robespierre

C. Marat

D. Danton

Answer: A

Q6. Why did Wordsworth not throw in his lot with the Girondist party in Paris?

A. He disagreed with their politics

B. He was imprisoned

C. He received a peremptory call from relatives and returned to England

D. He fell ill and had to leave

Answer: C

Q7. To whom did Wordsworth write an open letter defending the French Revolution upon his return to England?

A. Edmund Burke

B. The Bishop of Llandaff

C. The Prime Minister

D. King George III

Answer: B

Q8. How did critics initially treat Wordsworth's poetry?

A. With universal praise

B. With mild indifference

C. Almost unanimously with contempt

D. As the greatest poetry of the century

Answer: C

Q9. Who joined Wordsworth in the publication of the Lyrical Ballads in 1798?

A. Lord Byron

B. Percy Bysshe Shelley

C. Samuel Taylor Coleridge

D. Robert Southey

Answer: C

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Q10. In what year did William Wordsworth die?

A. 1843

B. 1850

C. 1855

D. 1860

Answer: B

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Page 183 - Lyrical Ballads

Q1. What event finally destroyed Wordsworth's faith in the French cause forever?

- A. The outbreak of war between France and England
- B. The Terror
- C. The fall of Robespierre
- D. The rise of Napoleon and the events which followed

Answer: D

Q2. How did Wordsworth's political views change over his life?

- A. He began as a conservative and ended as a radical
- B. He remained an extreme revolutionary his whole life
- C. He began as an adherent of the Revolution and ended as an extreme conservative
- D. He was always apolitical

Answer: C

Q3. Despite his later conservatism, Wordsworth's work remained a part of which great general movement of his time?

- A. The autocratic movement
- B. The democratic movement
- C. The neoclassical movement
- D. The imperialist movement

Answer: B

Q4. Which two literary movements did the 'Lyrical Ballads' mark the full development of?

- A. Classicism and Romanticism
- B. Romanticism and Naturalism
- C. Realism and Symbolism
- D. Modernism and Naturalism

Answer: B

Q5. According to Coleridge, what was the design of the collaborators in 'Lyrical Ballads'?

- A. To write only sonnets

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- B. To include two different kinds of poetry
- C. To revive classical Latin meters
- D. To mock the Augustan poets directly

Answer: B

Q6. In 'Lyrical Ballads', who was primarily responsible for the poems where incidents and agents were to be supernatural?

- A. William Wordsworth
- B. Samuel Taylor Coleridge
- C. Robert Southey
- D. William Blake

Answer: B

Q7. Which poem was Coleridge's single contribution to the 'Lyrical Ballads'?

- A. The Thorn
- B. Goody Blake
- C. The Ancient Mariner
- D. The Idiot Boy

Answer: C

Q8. In 'Lyrical Ballads', Wordsworth's contributions focused on subjects chosen from:

- A. Medieval history
- B. Greek mythology
- C. Ordinary life
- D. The French Revolution

Answer: C

Q9. Which of the following poems is one of Wordsworth's naturalistic contributions to the 'Lyrical Ballads'?

- A. The Ancient Mariner
- B. The Idiot Boy
- C. Christabel
- D. The Task

Answer: B

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Q10. What element prominent in his thought made Wordsworth an earnest supporter of English institutions and traditions?

- A. The desire for abstract liberty
- B. The sense of the sanctity of the past
- C. A belief in absolute monarchy
- D. His hatred for rural life

Answer: B

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Page 184 - Wordsworth's Theory of Poetry

Q1. Where did Wordsworth further set forth his aims for the 'Lyrical Ballads'?

- A. In the preface to the first edition
- B. In the preface to the second edition
- C. In a letter to Coleridge
- D. In his poem 'The Prelude'

Answer: B

Q2. According to Wordsworth's preface, what kind of life was generally chosen for his poems?

- A. Aristocratic court life
- B. Urban working-class life
- C. Humble and rustic life
- D. Military life

Answer: C

Q3. Why did Wordsworth prefer humble rustic life for his themes?

- A. Because the essential passions of the heart find a better soil and speak a plainer language there
- B. Because he wanted to mock country folk
- C. Because no other poet had ever written about it
- D. Because it was the most profitable subject to write about

Answer: A

Q4. Which poem is mentioned as a typical example of Wordsworth's choice of humble rustic themes?

- A. The Ancient Mariner
- B. The Prelude
- C. Michael
- D. The Task

Answer: C

Q5. Wordsworth famously attacked the practice of the Augustan school for its:

- A. 'Gaudiness and inane phraseology'
- B. 'Excessive emotionalism'

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C. 'Lack of rhyming structure'

D. 'Obsession with nature'

Answer: A

Q6. Did Wordsworth perfectly adhere to his own principles of using the language of actual life?

A. Yes, in every single poem he wrote

B. No, save in his early experiments, he did not himself adhere to his own principles

C. He only adhered to them in his prose works

D. He completely abandoned them after one month

Answer: B

Q7. How does Wordsworth guard himself against the accusation of absolute literal realism?

A. By writing only about supernatural ghosts

B. By emphasizing his use of imagination in the poetic transformation of his materials

C. By stating his poems are pure fiction

D. By writing in complex classical allegories

Answer: B

Q8. Wordsworth's use of imagination was a protest against the hard, literal treatment of life by which poet?

A. Alexander Pope

B. George Crabbe

C. Thomas Gray

D. John Keats

Answer: B

Q9. Which feature connects Wordsworth to the radical tendencies of the revolutionary age?

A. His firm belief in natural manhood

B. His support of the monarchy

C. His desire for industrial capitalism

D. His strict adherence to Augustan rules

Answer: A

Q10. Wordsworth's theory of poetic diction is another aspect of his general effort to:

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- A. Complicate poetry
- B. Pierce down through artifice and convention to nature and reality
- C. Make poetry an exclusive art for the educated elite
- D. Imitate classical Roman poets

Answer: B

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Page 185 - Characteristics of Wordsworth's Poetry

Q1. If Pope is the greatest poet of the town, what is Wordsworth?

- A. The greatest poet of the sea
- B. The greatest poet of the country and natural life
- C. The greatest poet of war
- D. The greatest poet of medieval chivalry

Answer: B

Q2. Wordsworth claimed he wrote always with his eye:

- A. 'Searching for the stars'
- B. 'Turned inward to the soul'
- C. 'Steadily fixed upon his object'
- D. 'Scanning the horizon'

Answer: C

Q3. What is said to be the most specific and personal quality in Wordsworth's nature poetry?

- A. The profound religious feeling which pervades it
- B. His precise botanical knowledge
- C. His use of complex rhyme schemes
- D. His rejection of any spiritual elements

Answer: A

Q4. For Wordsworth, nature was the embodiment of:

- A. Chaotic forces
- B. The Divine Spirit
- C. Human civilization
- D. Ancient mythology

Answer: B

Q5. Which of these poems exemplifies Wordsworth's profound religious feeling in nature?

- A. Lines written above Tintern Abbey
- B. The Rape of the Lock

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- C. The Village
- D. The Ancient Mariner

Answer: A

Q6. A fundamental principle in Wordsworth's philosophy is that the greatest of all teachers is:

- A. The Church
- B. Books
- C. Nature
- D. History

Answer: C

Q7. Wordsworth believed that spiritual communion is possible between the soul of man and:

- A. The spirits of the dead
- B. The indwelling Soul of the Universe
- C. Extraterrestrial beings
- D. Future generations

Answer: B

Q8. In what he writes about human life, Wordsworth's greatness is specially apparent as a:

- A. Satirist
- B. Dramatist
- C. Moralist
- D. Humorist

Answer: C

Q9. Wordsworth's greatness as a moralist results largely from his firm hold upon the central facts of:

- A. Economics and wealth
- B. Conduct and duty
- C. Social etiquette
- D. Political maneuvering

Answer: B

Q10. Wordsworth's emphasis is everywhere thrown upon:

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- A. External circumstances
- B. Spiritual forces within us that give us power over ourselves
- C. The inevitability of fate
- D. The necessity of formal education

Answer: B

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Page 186 - Wordsworth's Limitations and Coleridge

Q1. Which of the following is considered one of the obvious limitations of Wordsworth's genius?

- A. He had no humor and little passion
- B. He was too obsessed with urban life
- C. He wrote entirely in prose
- D. He relied too heavily on classical mythology

Answer: A

Q2. In which of his philosophical poems does Wordsworth often indulge in prolix moralisings of the dullest kind?

- A. Lyrical Ballads
- B. The Excursion
- C. Tintern Abbey
- D. Ode to Duty

Answer: B

Q3. Because he wrote an immense amount of perishable matter, it is said that Wordsworth gains by:

- A. Extensive rewriting
- B. Being read exclusively by scholars
- C. Judicious selection
- D. Being set to music

Answer: C

Q4. Samuel Taylor Coleridge was a boy at which school when the Bastille fell?

- A. Eton College
- B. Christ's Hospital
- C. Westminster School
- D. Rugby School

Answer: B

Q5. Who did Coleridge meet in 1794, later becoming his brother-in-law?

- A. William Wordsworth

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- B. Robert Southey
- C. Lord Byron
- D. Charles Lamb

Answer: B

Q6. What was the name of the utopian scheme for an ideal society that Coleridge and Southey planned?

- A. Pantisocracy
- B. Brook Farm
- C. New Harmony
- D. The Phalanstery

Answer: A

Q7. Where was this ideal society intended to be established?

- A. On the banks of the Thames
- B. In the Lake District
- C. On the banks of the Susquehanna River in America
- D. In the Scottish Highlands

Answer: C

Q8. Which poem did Coleridge himself call his 'recantation' regarding his revolutionary ideals?

- A. Religious Musings
- B. Ode to the Departing Year
- C. France: an Ode
- D. The Destiny of Nations

Answer: C

Q9. Like Wordsworth, Coleridge eventually allied himself definitely with which political cause?

- A. The radical Jacobins
- B. The conservative cause
- C. The socialist movement
- D. The anarchist movement

Answer: B

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Q10. What addiction helped to paralyse Coleridge's energies over many years?

- A. Alcohol
- B. Opium
- C. Gambling
- D. Tobacco

Answer: B